

worked hard, but made a vow never to work more hours than he and Julie agreed together would leave adequate time for the really important things.

DANGER SIGN: INDULGENCE

When you feel like you just have to go buy something to make yourself feel better, watch out; that's a danger sign.

It's not unusual for a young husband who is feeling the pressure of debts closing in on him to go out and buy a brand-new car. Why? Because it makes him feel better, at least for the moment. Buying things can be as addictive as any drug, because of the temporary "high" it creates. Unfortunately, it passes rather quickly for most people, usually when the first payment comes due.

My all-time record for indulgence was probably a doctor I met back in the mid '70s. I love machines myself, but try to limit my purchases to utilitarian items like chain saws and lawn mowers. I have to confess to buying my wife a chain saw for her birthday several years ago. That's when I found out she wasn't nearly as enamored with small machines as she had led me to believe.

But this doctor bought one of everything I ever wanted to own, including a steam locomotive. No, not a scale model, but a full-sized, narrow-gauge steam locomotive, weighing approximately 10 tons.

For his wife, that was the last straw. She had gone without new clothes while he filled their basement with lathes, drills, grinders, and old car parts, but this was too much—especially when she learned he was planning to have it transported to their backyard where he could get it into operational condition.

In my office, she said, "It's bad enough that we don't have any curtains on the back windows. But I'm not going to look out at a train engine all day."

The doctor finally got a museum to take the steam engine off his hands when he agreed to pay for the transportation costs of approximately \$8,000. His indulgent habits were not